EXPERIMENT NO: 2

Zoho Creator Setup and Platform Exploration

A step-by-step walkthrough of the Zoho Creator low-code platform, its core modules, and build workflow

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Low-Code Platform Evaluation Series

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1. Objective & Scope

This document records a hands-on exploration of Zoho Creator, a low-code application development platform. The goal is to understand the platform end to end — from account creation and sign-in, through the administrative console (applications, microservices, environments, mobile, portal, users, organization, governance, metrics, operations, and billing). Each section below documents one area of the platform, the steps taken to explore it, and the corresponding screenshot captured during that step.

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2. Getting Started — Landing Page & Sign-In

The exploration began at the public Zoho Creator marketing page, followed by the sign-in flow used to access the workspace.

1. Opened the Zoho Creator landing page, which highlights the platform's AI and low-code capabilities and offers a prompt box to describe an app in plain language.
2. Clicked **Sign In** and reached the authentication screen, which supports email/mobile sign-in as well as social and SSO options (Google, Facebook, LinkedIn, X, Apple, Microsoft, Zoho OneAuth).
3. Signed in successfully and landed on the account dashboard.

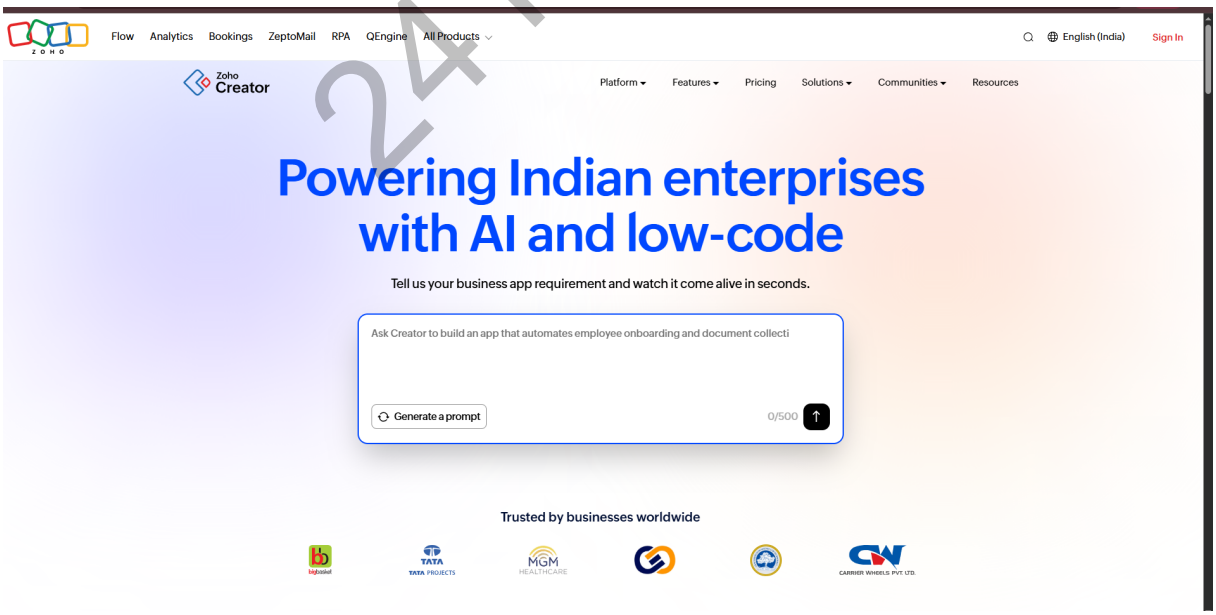


Fig 2.1 — Zoho Creator landing page with the AI app-generation prompt box.

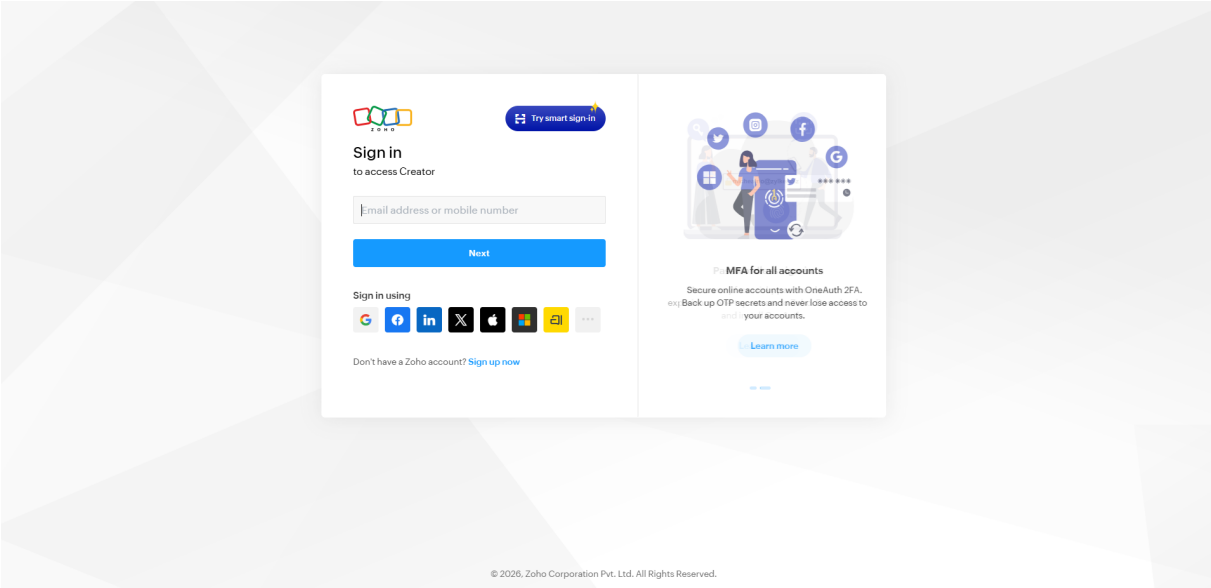


Fig 2.2 — Sign-in screen, showing email/mobile login and multiple SSO providers.

3. The Account Dashboard

After signing in, the account landed on the Creator home dashboard, which lists every application created under the organization and exposes the full left-hand navigation used throughout the rest of this report.

1. Landed on the dashboard showing **My first Creator app**, created on the account's first day.
2. Noted the left sidebar split into two groups: **Develop** (Applications, Microservices) and **Deploy** (Environments, Mobile, Portal), followed by a **Manage** group (Users, Organization, Governance, Metrics, Operations, Billing).
3. Confirmed the account identity in the top-left greeting: **Welcome, NEHALSEWIN 241401059**.



Fig 3.1 — Applications dashboard listing “My first Creator app”.

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4. Deployment Building Blocks — Microservices, Environments, Mobile & Portal

The Develop and Deploy sections were explored next, before any app-specific work, to understand what infrastructure Zoho Creator offers around an application.

1. **Microservices** — an empty state inviting creation of a modular component that connects to third-party apps or adds AI capability to an existing application.

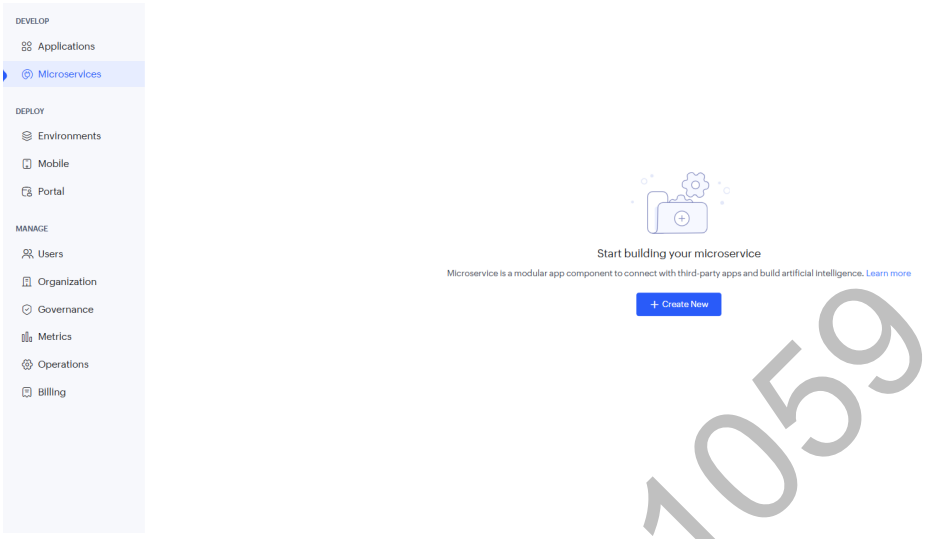


Fig 4.1 — Microservices module, empty state.

2. **Environments** — a two-column Stage/Production layout used to test an application before publishing it, without affecting the live version.

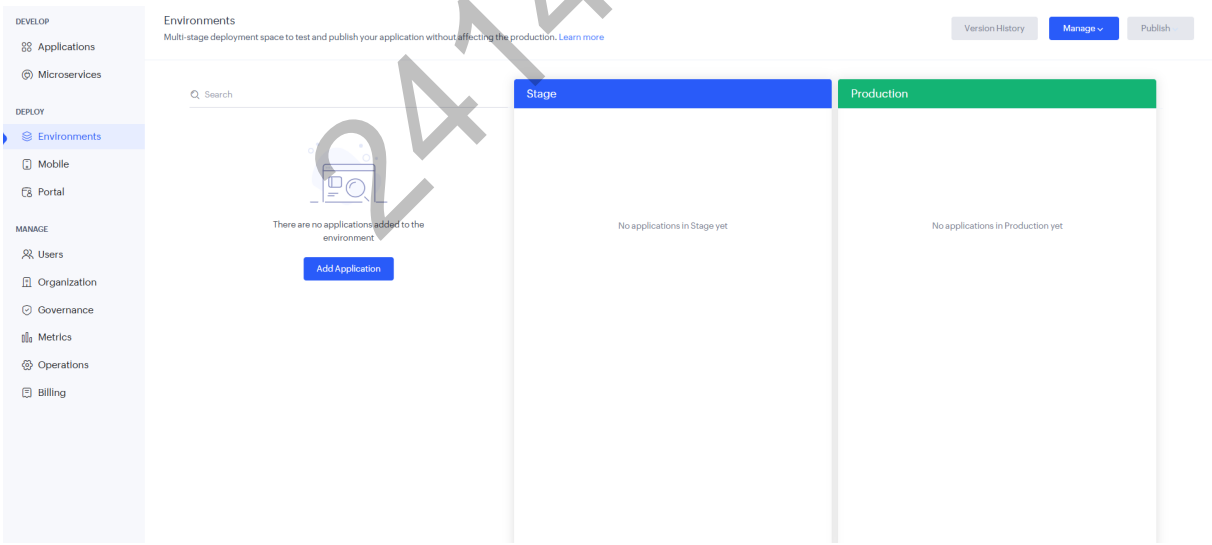


Fig 4.2 — Environments module showing empty Stage and Production columns.

3. **Mobile** — the option to package the application as a rebranded mobile app, or to distribute the generic Zoho Creator branded app for Android/iOS on the free tier.

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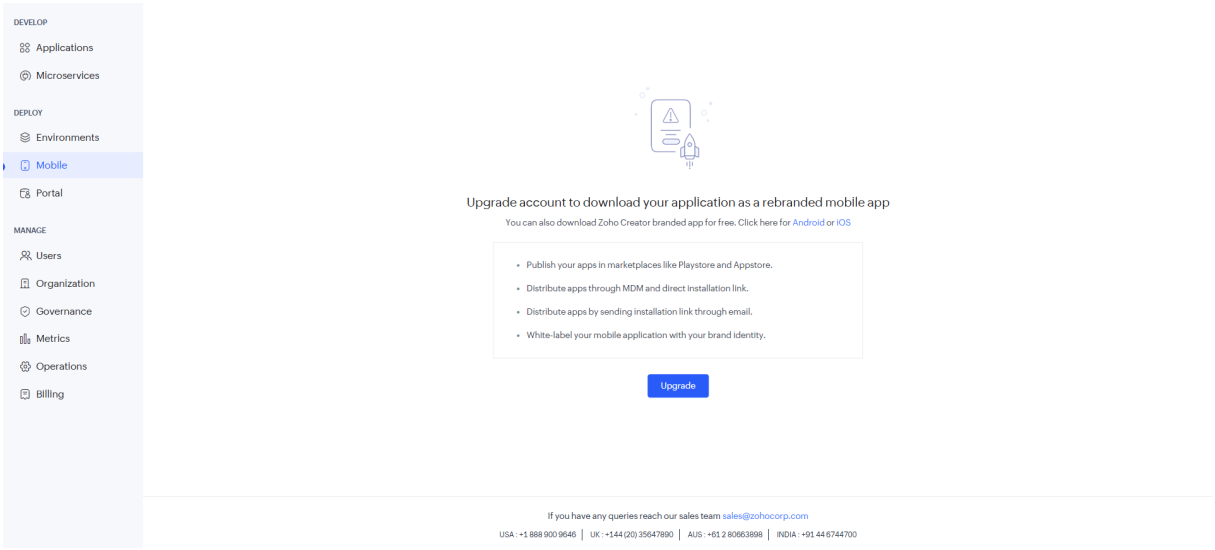
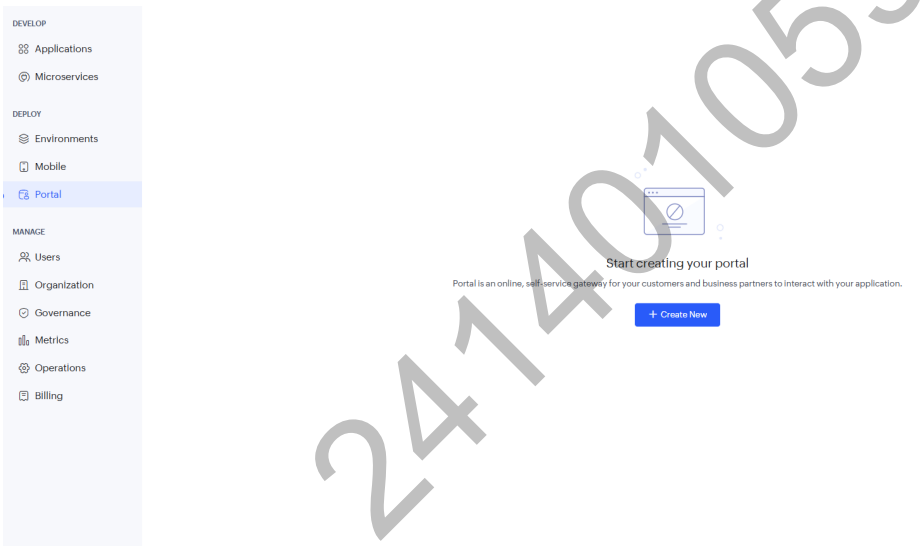


Fig 4.3 — Mobile module, prompting an account upgrade for a white-labelled app.

4. **Portal** — a self-service gateway that would let external customers or partners interact with the application once created.



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Fig 4.4 — Portal module, empty state.

5. Users & Organization Management

The Manage group was explored to understand how access control and organizational settings are configured.

1. **Users** — listed a single active user, the account owner, holding the **Super Admin** role, with columns for name, email address, and status.

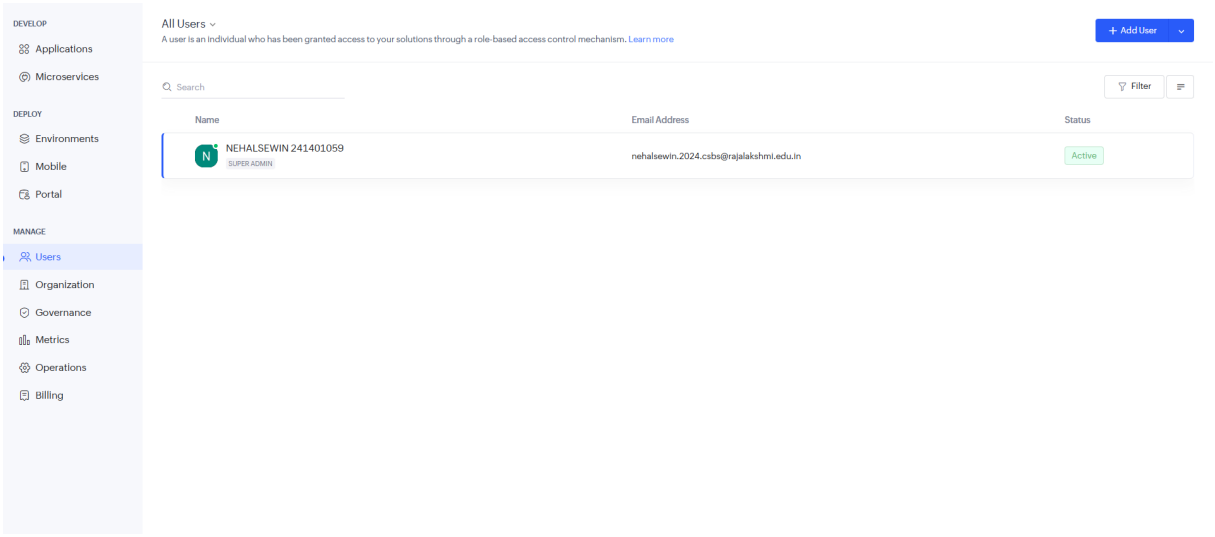
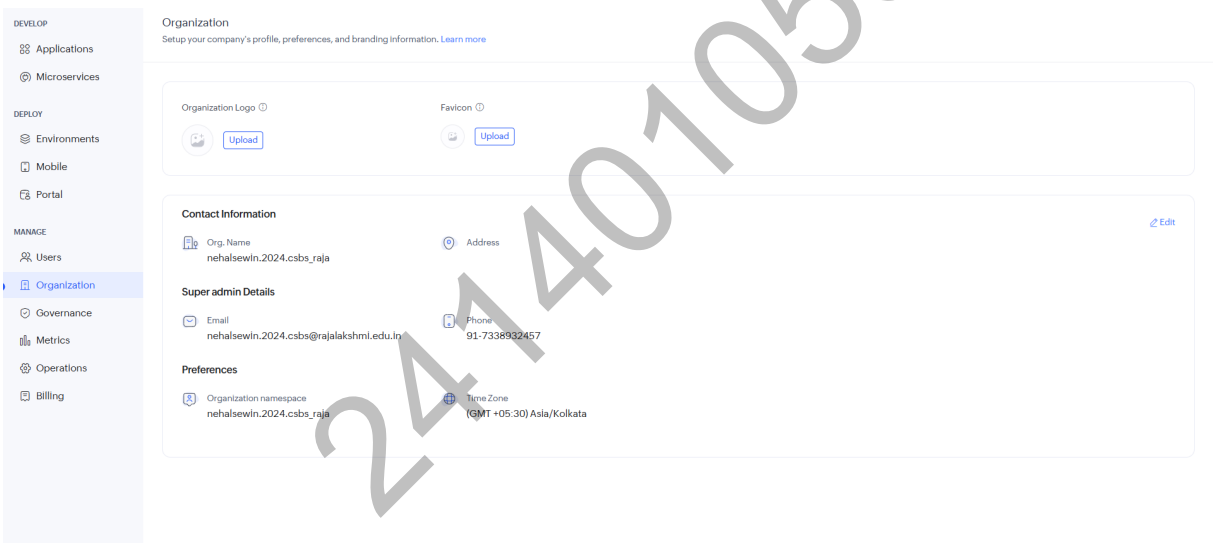


Fig 5.1 — All Users screen, showing the Super Admin as the sole active user.

2. **Organization** — captured company profile fields (organization name, address, logo, favicon), super admin contact details, and preferences such as organization namespace and time zone (GMT +05:30, Asia/Kolkata).



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Fig 5.2 — Organization profile and preferences screen.

6. Governance, Metrics & Operations

1. **Governance** — a Security Policies tab for configuring password rules and multi-factor authentication, alongside tabs for Custom Authentication, Active Directory, and Domains.

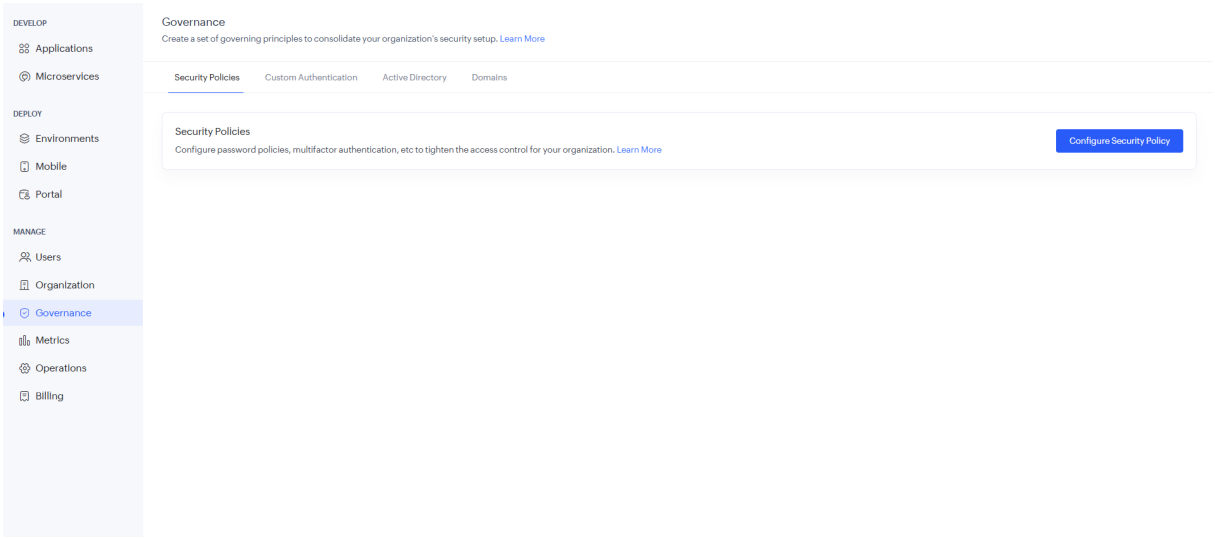
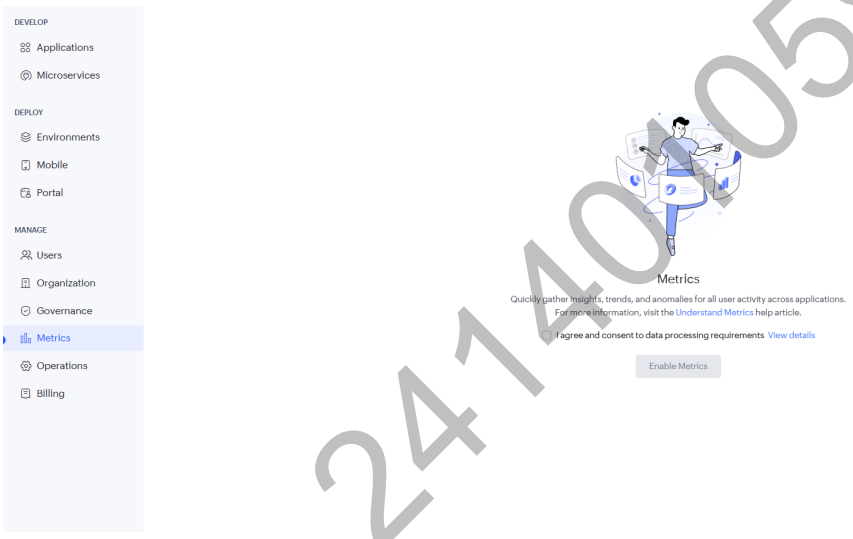


Fig 6.1 — Governance module, Security Policies tab.

2. **Metrics** — requires explicit consent to data processing before it can be enabled, after which it gathers insights, trends, and anomalies across all user activity in the organization.



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Fig 6.2 — Metrics module awaiting consent before activation.

3. **Operations** — a centralized panel of administrative tools grouped under Applications: Backup, Audit Trail, Email Management, Domain Restriction, API Management, Blueprint Analytics, Logs, Publish, Form Email, Marketplace, Support Access, System Integrations, Zia, Payment Gateways, and Databridge.

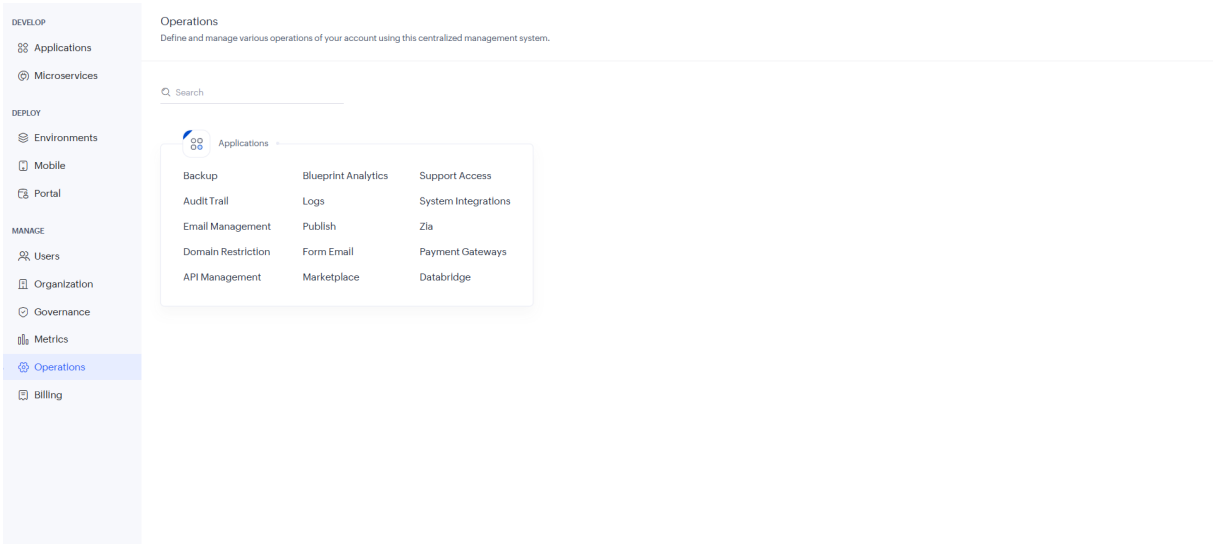


Fig 6.3 — Operations module listing all account-level administrative tools.

7. Billing & Subscription

1. Opened **Billing** and found the account on a trial, with **15 days** remaining.
2. Reviewed Plan Details: **1 of 10** users and **1 of Unlimited** apps consumed so far.
3. Noted an Upgrade Now call-to-action and a separate Usage Details tab for monitoring component-level consumption and setting custom alerts.

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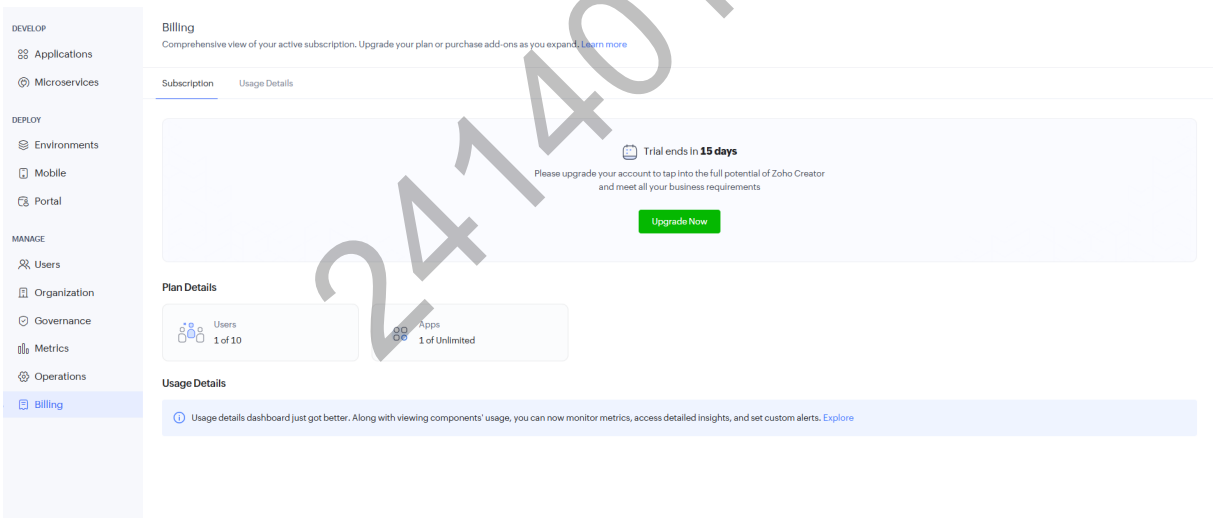


Fig 7.1 — Billing screen showing trial status and plan usage.